

TABLE 17.4
Multiple Regressions

Model	R	R-Squared	Adjusted R	Std. Error of the Estimate
1	0.517 ^a	0.267	0.236	3.57519

^a Anove.

Table 17.4 presents a significant relationship between family culture and job role and responsibilities.

TABLE 17.5
The Level of Significance

Model	Sum of Squares	Df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
Regression	442.622	4	110.655	8.657	0.000 ^a
Residual	1214.288	95	12.782		
Total	1656.910	99			

^a Coefficients.

Table 17.5 presents the variables of family involvement, family culture, long and irregular working hours, and job role and responsibilities.

TABLE 17.6
The Level of Significance

Model	Unstandardized Coefficients		Standardized Coefficients		Sig.
	B	Std. Error	Beta	T	
(Constant)	8.840	3.159		2.799	0.006
Family involvement	0.253	0.138	0.212	1.828	0.071
Family culture	0.217	0.175		1.238	0.219
Long and irregular working hours	0.101	0.124	0.083	0.815	0.417
Job role and Responsibilities	0.338	0.153	0.246	2.209	0.030

Table 17.6 presents the independent variable of family involvement, family culture, long and irregular working hours, and job role and responsibilities, which influences the work-life balance.

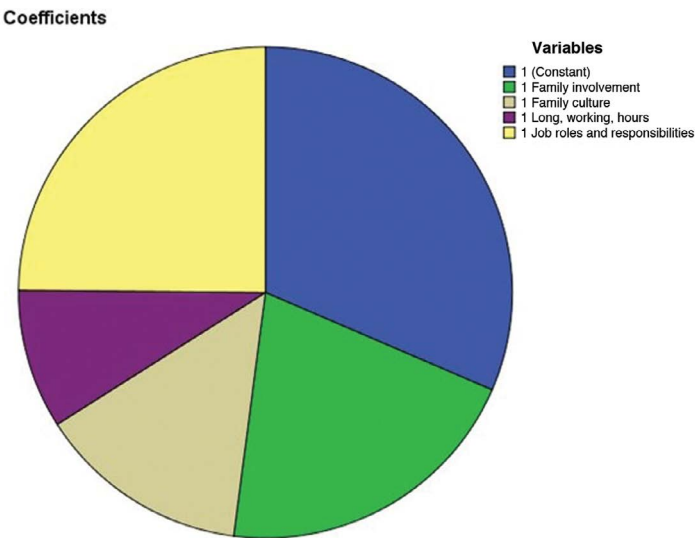


FIGURE 17.3 Regression coefficients of the charts for work-life balance of IT women employees.

Dependent variable: WLB

Predictors: (Constant), Family involvement, family culture, long and irregular working hours, and job role and responsibilities.

The level of significance is 0.000, which is less than 0.05, which indicates dependent variable work-life balance is significantly predicted by the independent variable of family involvement, family culture, long and irregular working hours, and job role and responsibilities, which influences the work-life balance at 95% of confidence level.

Dependent variable: WLB

Regression Equation: $\text{Work-life balance} = 8.840 + 0.253 * \text{Family involvement} + 0.217 * \text{Family culture} + 0.101 * \text{Long and irregular working hours} + 0.338 * \text{Job role and responsibilities}$. Regression coefficients of the charts have been explained through the pie chart as shown in Figure 17.3.

17.7 RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter discussed the women employees’ various personal challenges in terms of family involvement, family culture, and the professional challenges of long and irregular working hours, and how she can fulfill her job role and responsibilities while working in an IT company by balancing work and life (Misra et al., 2023).

In order to have good results, the variables of work-life balance and personal and professional challenges are segregated with the statements and asked to the IT women employees and their responses are keyed in the SPSS software, then it has been analyzed with, multiple correlations and multiple regressions.

It was found that there is a significant relationship between the employees’ personal and professional challenges. It was also found that the independent variable of

personal and professional challenges is significantly influencing the work-life balance. Furthermore, it was found that there is a significant difference between the various independent variables of family involvement, family culture, long and irregular working hours, and job role and responsibilities with the dependent variable of work-life balance.

These results are consistent with the findings of Young (2018), as the author asserts that, in an environment without typical work hour rules, the amount of working hours per week can be long, resulting in poor work-life balance. A drop in the number of working hours per week resulted in a better work-life balance.

Askari et al. (2019) explained that there is a positive correlation between the work-life balance and the various dimension of quality of work life. These results are also consistent with the findings of Bharathi (2016) that both personal and professional challenges are influencing the work-life balance of IT women employees.

This research finding revealed that the organizations can arrange for flexible working hours to avoid working long and irregular hours, as this will help the women employees to plan the schedule for the family's day-to-day activities, and this can balance both sides.

17.8 CONCLUSION

The study was performed to examine the work-life balance of IT women employees. As per this research, it was found that there is a significant relationship between personal and professional challenges. It was also found that personal and professional challenges are significantly influencing the work-life balance. Furthermore, there is a significant difference between the personal and professional challenges with work-life balance (Rani et al., 2021).

Working women have gained interest in this dynamic environment. Women's numbers have increased in various opportunities for professional work. In each one, there will be distinct demands in the profession, and they have to handle these without losing their personal life requirements. Finally, the outcome suggested that a woman IT employee is moderately managing various challenges they face in their personal and professional life (Vrushank et al., 2023b).

Organizations must establish and implement successful work-life balance policies, and employees must be encouraged to use these policies. Employees in the public sector are unaware of organizational policies regarding work-life balance. This could be included in an introduction session to ensure that workers are informed of company policies (Kumar, 2021).

Emerging issues about work-life balance and overwork have begun to challenge the prevailing working culture in modern society, which expects constant worker availability and emphasizes productivity as the primary benefit of digital technologies (Nevin et al., 2021).

In an environment without typical work-hour rules, the amount of working hours per week can be long, resulting to poor work-life balance, and a drop in the number of work hours per week resulted in an improved work-life balance (Young, 2018).

Employees are foundations of the organization. The firm should pay special attention to the well-being and needs of its personnel, so that employees can maintain a healthy balance between their professional and personal lives (Goyal et al., 2015).

The current study results have theoretical and practical implications for organizations. Border theory is a key, and the emphasis is that boundaries and bridges between work and family need to establish and sustain a desired balance and be properly controlled.

Border theory analyzes the organizational and personal variables that decide the complicated existence of work-family balance (Karassvidou et al., 2014). It's a theory that relates to how people manage and negotiate their work and family lives, as well as the limits that divide them, in order to achieve balance.

However many aspects of work and home are impractical to change, individuals can influence the nature of work and home, as well as the borders and bridges that connect them, to achieve a desired balance.

As per boundary theory, individuals regulate the boundaries between personal life and work by segmenting and/or integrating the domains, Work-family border theory clarifies how people navigate and work out the domains of family and work and the borders that separate them in order to maintain balance.

17.9 FUTURE DIRECTIONS

This research was done online. Future researchers can conduct this method offline, and it is possible to get even more reliable data (Rani et al., 2023).

The study used the method of questionnaire. Future research can try another possible method: interviews, group discussions, and surveys (Khanh et al., 2021).

In this study, respondents were selected from three IT companies located in Chennai. Future researchers can use different samples based on industry and demographic profiles.

This research has concentrated on personal and professional challenges variables. In the real life, there are many other challenges like time management, job security, and organizational culture, a researcher can go ahead on the same process with different analysis to get work-life balance results (Khang et al., 2022).

Although the majority of studies have been empirical, there is a scope for more extensive methods such as case studies, focus groups, and other approaches to bring more reasonable solutions for the IT industry. Future studies can focus their work-life balance of men employees (Rana et al., 2021).

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18 Challenges Faced by Marketers in Developing and Managing Contents in Workforce Development System

Ashwini Y. Sonawane and Alex Khang

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18.1 INTRODUCTION

In publishing, art, and communication, content is the information and experiences that are directed toward an end user or audience. Content is something that is to be expressed through some medium, as speech, writing, or any of various arts.

Content can be delivered via many different media, including the internet, cinema, television, smartphones, online courses, books, e-books, magazines, and live events, such as speeches, conferences, and stage performances in workforce development systems (Khang et al., 2023a).

The content itself is what the user derives value from. Thus, “content” can refer to the information provided through the medium, the way in which the information was presented, as well as the added features included in the medium in which that information was delivered. The medium, however, provides little to no value to the end user without the information and experiences that make up the content.

Communication theory philosopher Marshall McLuhan famously coined the phrase, “The medium is the message.” In the case of content, the channel through which information is delivered, the “medium,” affects how the end user perceives content, the “message” (Babasaheb et al., 2023a).

The author, producer, or publisher of an original source of information or experiences may or may not be directly responsible for the entire value that they attain as content in a specific context. For example, part of an original article (such as a headline from a news story) may be rendered on another web page, displaying the results of a user’s search engine query grouped with headlines from other news publications and related advertisements.

In this chapter, the value that the original headline has in this group of query results from the search engine as a medium may be very different from the value that it had as message content in its original article (Snehal et al., 2023).

Content also influences other people to create their own content, sometimes in a way that the original author did not or could not plan or imagine. This feature, adding the option of user innovation in a medium, means that users can develop their own content from existing content.

Traditionally, content was edited and tailored for the public through news editors, authors, and other kinds of content creators. However, not all information content requires creative authoring or editing.

Through recent technological developments, the truth is found in McLuhan’s idea of a global village; new technologies, such as smartphones and automated sensors, that allow for instantaneous movement of information from every corner to every point at the same time have caused the globe to be contracted into a village. These new technologies can record events anywhere for publishing and converting/conversion (data transformation) in order to potentially reach a global audience through various internet channels such as YouTube. Such recorded or transmitted information and visuals can be referred to as contents (Babasaheb et al., 2023b).

Content is no longer a product of only reputable sources; new technology has made primary sources of content more readily available to all, for example, a video of a politician giving a speech compared to an article written by a reporter who witnessed the speech.

Media production and delivery technology may potentially enhance the value of content by formatting, filtering, and combining original sources of content for new audiences with new contexts. The greatest value for a given source of content is often found through such electronic reworking of contents as well as dynamic or real-time as the trends that fuel its interest a specific audience (Gupta et al., 2023).

Less emphasis on value from content stored for possible use in its original form, and more emphasis on rapid repurposing, reuse, and redeployment has led many publishers and media producers to view their primary function less as originators and more as transformers of content. Thus, one finds out that institutions, which used to focus on publishing printed materials, are now publishing both databases and software to combine content from various sources for a wider variety of audiences (Khang et al., 2024).

Content management (CM) is a set of processes and technologies that support the collection, managing, and publishing of information in any form or medium. When stored and accessed via computers, this information may be more specifically referred to as digital content, or simply as content.

Digital content may take the form of text (such as electronic documents), multimedia files (such as audio or video files), or any other file type that follows a content lifecycle requiring management (Jain et al., 2023).

The process is complex enough to manage that several large and small commercial software vendors, such as Interwoven and Microsoft, offer CM software to control and automate significant aspects of the content lifecycle.

CM practices and goals vary by mission and by organizational governance structure. News organizations, e-commerce websites, and educational institutions all use content management, but in different ways. This leads to differences in terminology and in the names and number of steps in the process.

For example, some digital content is created by one or more authors. Over time that content may be edited. One or more individuals may provide some editorial oversight, approving the content for publication.

Publishing may take many forms. It may be the act of “pushing” content out to others or simply granting digital access rights to certain content to one or more individuals. Later that content may be superseded by another version of the content and thus retired or removed from use.

CM is an inherently collaborative process. It often consists of the following basic roles and responsibilities:

- **Creator** – responsible for creating and editing content.
- **Editor** – responsible for tuning the content message and the style of delivery, including translation and localization.
- **Publisher** – responsible for releasing the content for use.
- **Administrator** – responsible for managing access permissions to folders and files, usually accomplished by assigning access rights to user groups or roles. Admins may also assist and support users in various ways.
- **Consumer, viewer, or guest** – the person who reads or otherwise takes in content after it is published or shared.

A critical aspect of CM is the ability to manage versions of content as it evolves. Authors and editors often need to restore older versions of edited products due to a process failure or an undesirable series of edits.

Another equally important aspect of CM involves the creation, maintenance, and application of review standards. Each member of the content creation and review

process has a unique role and set of responsibilities in the development or publication of the content. Each review team member requires clear and concise review standards. These must be maintained on an ongoing basis to ensure the long-term consistency and health of the knowledge base.

18.2 RELATED WORK

Theories of content marketing marketers (CMMs) around the world are getting to know content marketing. There are many theories of content marketing available. Most of them are quite similar, so a few will be listed for discussion.

Berger and Milkman (2012) suggests that viral content is a hyper-effective mechanism to expand one's subjective lens of one's prior experiences. He proposes a theory that what makes people share a piece of content is when viral contents "represent or uncover something pleasurable that we could never have conceived with our own minds." This proposal is proven by Berger and Milkman (2012) in their scientific research about vitality, which is discussed later in this chapter.

18.2.1 TERMINOLOGIES AND DEFINITIONS

Content Marketing, the term is relatively new, there are many similar definitions of content marketing. According to Mandloys Digital Marketing (2013), content marketing is:

The creation of content that is relevant, compelling, entertaining, and valuable and this content must be consistently provided to maintain or change the behavior of customers. Content marketing is an essential marketing activity that helps retain customers, acquire new ones and helps companies to build a strong brand.

This agency suggests that the purpose of content marketing is to educate consumers by providing valuable information. Then the content will create brand loyalty and purchases will be made in the future. They also state that this relatively new form of marketing normally does not involve direct selling. Instead, the audience is encouraged to make the purchase from said company whenever they are ready.

However, there is one thing Mandloys Digital Marketing (2013) does not mention in their definition of content marketing that Copyblogger (2013) does: "Content marketing means creating and sharing valuable free content to attract and convert prospects into customers, and customers into repeat buyers." They think the content should be free to encourage the audience to access, consume and share.

Copyblogger (2013) also think the content that is shared should be related to the field and category of the business so that the audience is educated. Then they will "know, like and trust" the company to be able to do business with it in the future. Here are relevant terms that are often interchanged with content marketing; in other words, they are very similar to the term "content marketing." The list is provided by Pulizzi et al. (2009):

- Custom publishing
- Custom media

- Corporate content
- Corporate media
- Custom content
- Branded content
- Branded editorial
- Branded editorial content
- Branded storytelling
- Information marketing
- Advertorial
- Private media
- Customer publishing
- Customer media
- Contract publishing
- Corporate publishing
- Corporate journalism
- Member media
- Info-content

18.2.2 OTHER TERMS USED IN THIS CONTEXT

Viral: Today's electronic equivalent of old-fashioned word of mouth. It's a marketing strategy that involves creating an online message that's novel or entertaining enough to prompt consumers to pass it on to others – spreading the message across the web like a virus at no cost to the advertiser.

Pipeline: This term is often the warehouse for the collection of active leads that have had some level of follow-up qualification.

Pipeline Value: Value of all of the sales opportunities in your pipeline.

Funnel Conversion: A technical term used in e-commerce operations to describe the track a consumer takes through an internet advertising or search system, navigating an e-commerce website and finally converting to a sale.

Click-Through Rate (CTR): A way of measuring the success of an online advertising campaign for a particular website as well as the effectiveness of an email campaign by the number of users that clicked on a specific link.

Qualified Leads: Prospective customers who have a demonstrated interest in the product or service being sold, the ability to pay, or the authority to make a purchase decision.

Quantitative Social Media Measuring: A methodology that focuses on counting the volume of specific types of content on the social web.

Qualitative Social Media Measuring: The process of accessing the opinions and beliefs about a brand.

Sentiment Analysis or Opinion Mining: The use of computer algorithms to automatically detect the basic mood, attitudes, or emotions of the creators of content on the social web.

Net Promoter Score: A qualitative measurement used to gauge the loyalty of a company's customer relationships. The score is obtained by asking

customers how likely they are to recommend the company to their connections. The scale is from 0 to 10, where those who score 9–10 are Promoters. Those with 7–8 are Passives, and the rest are Detractors.

Reach: The percentage of people in a target market who are exposed to an advertising schedule at least once.

Frequency: The number of times an individual views a commercial in a particular advertising schedule.

Impact: This is to be understood as raising people's awareness of a brand and influencing their perception of the brand through engagement. However, it is necessary to discuss further the benefits, as well as drawbacks, of content marketing.

Pulizzi et al. (2009) explain six reasons businesses are making the change to content marketing:

There is a change in buyer attitudes toward traditional media and the credibility of content:

- Buyers need content that makes them smarter and more knowledgeable.
- Traditional media sources can't be counted on to assist you in reaching your customers. Social media tools can provide better and more buyer data than traditional media partners.
- Media companies are shrinking their budgets, thus reducing content quality. These continued cutbacks reveal significant opportunity for businesses to become the publishers themselves to attract information-thirsty customers.
- Selling to your customers is becoming more challenging. Even though traditional marketing will always work, it is clear that the future of marketing will be centered on conversations and engagement between business and customers.
- Because technology is both cheap and easy to use, even small companies can deliver great content solutions to a targeted customer base. By becoming the publishers themselves, businesses can gather a huge amount of data relating to current and future customers easily and inexpensively. They can say goodbye to the middleman.
- High-quality editorial content from the business expert is trusted. The company should be the expert of their own field; therefore, they should possess the most trusted content resource that will attract and retain customers and prospects.

Oppflow (2013) says there are four reasons business should use content marketing:

- If you don't create content, no one will find you. If search engines can't find your content, your business can't be found by the customer either.
- Quality content gets shared. In this world dominated by social networks, the share-ability of content defines the success. Virality is what every content marketer should aim for.

- Expert content builds trust. Similar to Pulizzi and Barrett, Oppflow agrees that content written with expertise by the business will help to create trust.
- Content generates traffic and leads. Lead generation is especially important in the B2B sector, and good content can help increase traffic to the company website, thus increasing brand awareness and the chance of connecting with prospective buyers.

18.3 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The entire research is predominantly carried out by thoughtful analysis and deep diving into the available secondary data to generate new insights which would prove relevant to the business scenario of today (Rani et al., 2021).

Multiple online sources and blogs have been used and referred to as in-depth learning about a topic can be attained. It is a critical decision to ascertain which sources of data must be referred to. This is due to extreme cluttering of data all across the web. Each resource used and referred to in the making of this report was carefully judged, and only the resources that came with a credible name were used (Bhambri et al., 2022).

For each of the three objectives stated below, a similar process has been carried out for the purpose of drawing insights and conclusions. The process involved referring to past research and chapters published on similar, relating, and relevant subjects, and extending the findings and conclusions drawn to the context of this research.

Each section of this chapter deals with the challenges faced by small and large organizations when it comes to effective creation and management of meaningful content for three major purposes:

Objective 1: Associated with lead generation: To find challenges and propose solutions to when the published content fails to generate leads.

Objective 2: Associated with brand awareness: To find challenges and propose solutions to when the published content fails to create intended brand awareness.

Objective 3: Associated with thought leadership: To find challenges and propose solutions to when the published content fails to position the company as an expert (of their domain).

18.4 CONTENT-ASSOCIATED FAILURE TO GENERATE LEADS

Objective 1: Associated with lead generation: To find challenges and propose solutions to when the published content fails to generate leads. Content is the foundation of a company's lead generation and leads to nurturing efforts.

Marketers have come to rely on content to engage prospects and customers in today's buyer landscape, but to do so, the content must educate, inspire, and beg to be shared. It should help leads overcome challenges and achieve their aspirations. If it is able to do that, lead generation will be more efficient and frequent.

Issue #1: Published content doesn't solve problems

One of the main aims of content marketing is to help people before they actually purchase a product. By helping people before a transaction takes place, the company would be able to do a couple of things:

- First, it's able to position itself as an authority on the subject matter that the business is associated with.
- Second, it is able to build some goodwill and subsequent trust.

That's because it has already demonstrated its expertise and given people strategies that they can implement in their own businesses – all without asking for anything in return. Once people understand that what the company is saying is of value, they begin to trust more.

If the content is not helping people to solve a problem, readers have little reason to believe that it is going to be of value to them.

After all, the company hasn't provided them with tactics or strategies that they can implement in their own businesses to generate results – meaning they can't accurately judge whether or not it is the real deal.

If the content is not generating leads, the company will want to take a long, hard look at its current forms of content and ask if what it has produced is helping the audience solve problems.

Plus, there's another reason it needs to produce content that solves problems, and it's this – content that doesn't solve problems won't be searched for in the search engines.

If a company is having trouble generating leads, it can be tempting to buy email lists so it can feed the sales department with something – anything. But buying or renting contacts out of desperation will cause more long-term (and short-term) harm than good. There are a lot of reasons buying email lists is never a good idea. Not only will sending emails to purchased lists harm the email deliverability and IP reputation, but there's a good chance the people on the purchased list have never heard of approaching company – making them far more likely to mark the emails as spam. They'll also find it to be annoying. Bottom line here is that quality email addresses simply aren't for sale. The whole point of generating leads is to eventually nurture those leads into customers. In order for the leads to become customers, the generated leads need to actually want to hear from the company.

Suggested solution

The leads need to opt in, plain and simple. This means the contacts chose to give their information in exchange for something valuable, like a content offer, webinar, event, and so on. It is important to focus on creating offers that are valuable in some way for the target audience, and then package that value and put it behind a lead capture form.

Growing a healthy, opt-in email list takes time, but it's worth its weight in gold down the line. And once an organization has people to email, it must be sure to create remarkable email content that makes people want to actually open the emails and stay subscribed.

The following steps can be taken to create value for the customers:**Step 1:** Understand what drives value for your customers.

Talk to them, survey them, and watch their actions and reactions. In short, capture data to understand what is important to your customers and what opportunities you have to help them.

Step 2: Understand your value proposition.

The value customers receive is equal to the benefits of a product or service minus its costs. What value does your product or service create for them? What does it cost them in terms of price plus any ancillary costs of ownership or usage (e.g., how much of their time do they have to devote to buying or using your product or service?)

Step 3: Identify the customers and segments where you can create more value relative to competitors.

Different customers will have varying perceptions of your value relative to your competitors, based on geographic proximity, for example, or a product attribute that one segment may find particularly attractive.

Step 4: Create a win-win price.

Set a price that makes it clear that customers are receiving value but also maximizes your “take.” Satisfied customers that perceive a lot of value in your offering are usually willing to pay more, while unsatisfied customers will leave, even at a low price. Using “cost-plus” pricing (i.e., pricing at some fixed multiple of product costs) often results in giving away margin unnecessarily to some customers while losing incremental profits from others.

Step 5: Focus investments on your most valuable customers.

Disproportionately allocate your sales force, marketing dollars, and R&D investments toward the customers and segments that you can best serve and that will provide the greatest value in return. Also, allocate your growth capital toward new products and solutions that serve your best customers or can attract more customers that are similar to your best customers.

Your customers are the lifeblood of your business. They are the source of current profits and the foundation of future growth. These steps will help you find more ways to grow your business by better serving your best customers.

Issue #2: The organization doesn't offer lead generation content for people in different stages of the buyer's journey.

Not everyone who visits a website is going to be at the same stage of the buyer's journey. Certain visitors may be landing on the website for the very first time. These people would never be ready to see a product demo yet. It is more likely that they'd want to download a helpful piece of content, like a step-by-step guide or anything that serves an educational purpose.

Some of the site visitors might be ready to buy, but most won't – and they must be given opportunities to learn more about the business and what it is selling before asking them to take any sort of purchase action. Creating valuable content to teach

and nurture leads down the funnel is time-consuming, which is why so often a business's website contains nothing but "Buy Now!" and "Click Here for a Free Demo!" and similar calls to action (CTAs) which do more harm than good.

Suggested solution:

There is no standardized set of CTAs for everyone who visits a website. To maximize click-through rates, the company must want to cater to visitors who are at different stages of the buyer's journey using customized CTAs. It will need to spend time creating a variety of offers that it can put behind landing page forms that cater to people at different stages.

Visitors who are just starting to get to know the company might be interested in offers like checklists, contests, and templates. Visitors who are a little further down the funnel might be interested in email courses, kits, and whitepapers. Visitors even further down might be ready for a demo. An organization must make sure that it is creating content that covers the whole funnel and that it is offering this content on the website, so there's something for everyone who lands there.

The organization must take personalization a step further by using smart CTAs. Smart CTAs are CTAs that change depending on the person viewing the page – his or her interests, location, pages viewed already, items or services bought before, and so on. Unsurprisingly, personalized CTAs actually convert 42% more visitors than basic calls to action. They make the visitor experience more meaningful and also result in higher conversion rates. Tips to create an efficient CTA button:

1. **Stand out with contrasting colors:** Colors matter a lot when it is about achieving a massive conversion rate. A highly effective CTA ensures a brilliant use of contrasting colors that stand out from the rest of the background. There is no exact answer about which color works best. So, you have to apply and test different colors to see which color can give you better conversions. It all depends on the design of your website and what would definitely grab a user's attention. While doing so, ensure that it still resonates with the overall look and feel of your brand.
2. **Ensure the right size and shape:** Your button must be big enough to draw the visitor's attention instantly and also make it easy for the user to click on it. Plus, the shape of the button also plays a vital role in getting the required conversions.

A simple rectangular or rounded shape can experiment. Depending on the design and other settings of your store, any shape might work well for you. Most of the e-commerce websites make use of rectangular buttons to make them more visible.

3. **Invoke a sense of urgency:** By showing a deadline for a scheme or lack of stock, you make the users more inclined to buy your products.

It is crucial to creating a sense of urgency by using words like "Now," "Hurry," "Quickly," "Limited Edition," and so on. When people find that stock is limited, they rush to grab the product instantly, thus ultimately leading to an increase in conversions.

4. **Craft CTA copy with unique words:** In order to grab a user's attention, play with the power of words and craft highly compelling copy for a CTA button.
Using something unique instead of "Submit," "Shop Now," or "Buy" will definitely catch the user's eye and compel them to take action. Some powerful and unique words should be incorporated to get the users more inclined toward your CTA button.
5. **Incorporate value proposition:** Another exciting element that gives an instant boost in proposition is stating the value proposition in the CTA button. The audience must be shown what they will get back in exchange for taking action.
Stating value proposition like "Free Guide" or "Save up to 25%" in a CTA button clearly explains to the visitor what they are going to get in return for their action.
6. **Use action-oriented words:** You have to persuade the audience to click the CTA button. This is where your copy would actually convert into actions. Using action-oriented words or phrases guides the user about what he/she should do next. Some of the best action words and phrases are:
 - Shop Now
 - Add to Bag
 - Get Access
 - Join
 - Subscribe
 - Place Your Order
 - Checkout
7. **Get personal in CTA:** Make your visitors feel comfortable with personalized CTA. It is a common practice to incorporate the second person, such as "You" and "Your," for a more personal touch. This enables a user to take the action more promptly and hence proposition rates.

Issue #3: The published content is not providing a fresh look at things or worse is boring.

Interesting content is one of the main reasons people follow brands on social media. If the organization writes and publishes a piece of content, say, a blog post, on a topic that is already saturated, it cannot be guaranteed that new leads will be attracted to spend time and effort reading the blog post, let alone using the CTAs. After all, there's probably not a topic in any industry that hasn't been extensively covered already.

Suggested solution:

From time to time, individuals browsing the internet actually do read a blog post associated with these topics. This is because the content approaches things from a different angle and provides a fresh look.

If a blog post or any piece of content can teach people something new about a topic that they previously thought they already knew a lot about, the posting organization can garner a lot of credibility. This is mainly because it showcases how much

of an expert one is on the topic. There are a few ways in which one can take tired content topics and make them interesting.

Nine Characteristics of Successful Content:

1. **Targeted:** Before you even begin writing, you should know WHO you are writing for and center the content on a topic that will pique their interest. Having a comprehensive understanding of your target audience will allow content to speak to their unique needs and interests. By targeting content at a particular group, you can highlight specific benefits and information that will be relevant to them.

One can target content at their audience by utilizing buyer personas for each segment of their target audience. Also, website analytics can be used to see who is visiting your site and viewing your content. Half the challenge of content marketing is getting an audience to consume the content. In addition to writing directly to a specific audience, you can use search engine optimization (SEO) to make your content more discoverable.

2. **Optimized:** SEO is a strategy to have your original content rank higher in search results. It is used by individuals and organizations to increase the visibility of their content. It has become so common that an industry of “growth hackers” and “SEO gurus” has developed to help businesses rank higher in search results.

SEO has proven to bring results. Keywords, the quality of the content, how much activity the website that hosts the content experiences, and several other factors contribute to the success of SEO efforts. Another form of optimization is social media optimization (SMO). SMO deals with increasing your business’ visibility and improving your reputation using social platforms such as Facebook, Twitter, and LinkedIn.

Successful content needs to be written for the audience first, with optimization in the back of your mind throughout the process. You put in the effort to create valuable, high-performing content. SEO and SMO will make it easily discoverable by members of the intended audience.

3. **Provides Value:** Perhaps the most important question to ask about content is “Does it provide value to the intended audience?” You can provide value in many ways. To provide value, you should educate, entertain, or solve a problem your audience might be having. Your content should not only be used to promote your services, it should be created to benefit your audience. If the target audience does not see value in what you are sharing, they will ignore you.

To learn more about providing value through content, take a look at our article Jodi Harris (2023) “The One Thing You Need To Include in Your Newsletter.” Newsletters are just like any other form of content; they need to be a valuable use of the readers’ time.

4. **Tells a Story:** Storytelling is among the most effective methods for communicating information. The way stories speak to the human brain is unique, effectively motivating action centers within the brain. This

phenomenon does not occur with any other methods of communicating information. It might not always be possible to tell a story through your content, but the more you can do it, the more value you can add to your content marketing efforts.

To learn more about how to tell engaging stories in your business, our article Jodi Harris (2023) “The Power of Storytelling in the Business World” examines why storytelling can be a great tool for businesses to communicate information to their audience.

5. **Educational:** Your content should be somewhat educational for your audience. There is little point in simply rehashing information that the user already knows. Content should have the purpose of informing your readers about something they need to know about your product, service, business, or industry. You can educate your audience with any content imaginable.

Content written well below your audience’s level of knowledge may offend them, pushing them away from your website and toward your competitors.

6. **Captivating:** Capturing your audience’s attention is a difficult task, something that many content marketers struggle with on a daily basis. You want to capture the attention of your readers so they become engaged with the message. Engaged users are members of your audience who actively pay attention to your content. Those users are “listening” to what you are saying.

How can you capture an audience? Some tactics go a long way toward engaging your readers. By speaking directly to your audience, asking them questions, and using a consistent tone of voice, you can engage and captivate your readers. Content should always aim to grab and hold the attention of an audience.

7. **Shareable:** Your content needs to find a way to get in front of the members of your target audience. One way for that to happen is by creating highly shareable content. You need to distribute content through channels where you know you can find your audience. At the very least you should use digital channels where you know your content can get in front of the users with interest.

If your content is flawless but doesn’t get seen, is it as valuable as it should be? Writing content that aligns with your business strategy does not have to be an overly complicated endeavor. Just create a website that can host your content (a blog or resources section) and share that content across various social platforms, email, and other relevant forums.

If your audience can find your content, and that content is high-quality, then they will share it with other individuals, thus spreading the reach of your content.

8. **Persuasive:** Regardless of which stage of the buyer’s journey the reader is on, your content should aim to motivate action. If the reader is in the early stages of the purchase cycle, your content should convince them to learn more about your brand (or products/services).

If they are in the later legs of the journey, it should persuade or motivate them to take that next step, finally becoming a customer. Target every piece

of content toward a particular stage of the sales process with a focus on the beginning and ending stages.

A technique exists called “pre-suasion,” which means priming your audience to convert to customers using the content. This method positions your message so that before you even deliver it, the audience already agrees. Pre-suasion involves using visuals, phrasing, how you order details in the content, and understanding why your brand (or content) appeals to customers.

The book *Pre-Suasion: A Revolutionary Way to Influence and Persuade*, by Cialdini et al. (2016), examines how effective persuasion does not lie in the message itself, but in the critical moment right before the delivery of that message. Persuasive content can lead to conversions, helping you gain customers and grow your business.

9. **Converting:** What’s the end goal of content marketing? It’s likely to attract profitable customers to your business. That’s why it’s important for your content to contain a CTA. That CTA does not have to motivate a purchase, which is not always appropriate, but a good marketer will always include a CTA.

That might mean asking your audience to like, comment, share, or retweet your content on social media. The CTA might encourage the audience to visit other resources or to subscribe to your newsletter or YouTube channel. Regardless of what you want to motivate, your content should nudge the audience into the next step of the journey.

18.5 CONTENT-ASSOCIATED FAILURE TO CREATE BRAND AWARENESS

Objective 2: To find challenges and propose solutions to when the published content fails to create intended brand awareness.

18.5.1 BRAND AWARENESS

Brand awareness refers to the extent to which customers are able to recall or recognize a brand. Brand awareness is a key consideration in consumer behavior, advertising management, brand management, and strategy development. The consumer’s ability to recognize or recall a brand is central to purchasing decision-making.

Purchasing cannot proceed unless a consumer is first aware of a product category and a brand within that category. Awareness does not necessarily mean that the consumer must be able to recall a specific brand name, but he or she must be able to recall sufficient distinguishing features for purchasing to proceed. For instance, if a consumer asks their friend to buy them some gum in a “blue pack,” the friend would be expected to know which gum to buy, even though neither friend can recall the precise brand name at the time.

Different types of brand awareness have been identified, namely brand recall and brand recognition. Key researchers argue that these different types of awareness operate in fundamentally different ways and that this has important implications for the purchase decision process and marketing communications.

Brand awareness is closely related to concepts such as the evoked set and consideration set, which describe specific aspects of the consumer's purchase decision. Consumers are believed to hold between three and seven brands in their consideration set across a broad range of product categories. Consumers will normally purchase one of the top three brands in their consideration set.

Brand awareness is a key indicator of a brand's competitive market performance. Given the importance of brand awareness in consumer purchasing decisions, marketers have developed a number of metrics designed to measure brand awareness and other measures of brand health. These metrics are collectively known as awareness, attitudes, and usage (AAU) metrics.

To ensure a product or brand's market success, awareness levels must be managed across the entire product life cycle – from product launch through to market decline. Many marketers regularly monitor brand awareness levels, and if they fall below a predetermined threshold, the advertising and promotional effort are intensified until awareness returns to the desired level.

18.5.2 IMPORTANCE OF BRAND AWARENESS

The most effective way to make the content stand out and garner the attention it deserves is to make sure the brand aligns with the content. This level of strategic content marketing helps build brand awareness and strengthen the company's reputation.

Building brand awareness through content marketing is not as difficult as one might think, but it does require strategic planning. Here are some tips to help develop a content marketing strategy that fosters brand awareness.

Issue #1: The published content fails to create brand awareness.

Suggested solution:

The process prescribed below guarantees to deliver the intended results behind any campaign with the aim of generating brand awareness.

Define Your Brand.

A company can't create content to build the brand if it hasn't clearly defined what the brand is. When defining the brand, the following points need to be considered:

- **Vision** – Every company should have a clear and concise mission statement that defines its core values and goals. All content the company produces should highlight the company's values and help it meet those goals.
- **Value** – Companies also need to have a clear understanding of what value they bring to the industry and to the customer. Are they thought leaders? Industry experts? A valuable resource? You should know the value the company offers before starting a content marketing plan.
- **Voice** – It also is important to determine the company's voice. Does one want to be seen as authoritative, friendly, customer-centric, or something else? Whatever style one chooses, make sure it matches the core mission and helps build relationships with the customers.

Understand the Target Customer.

In addition to understanding the brand, one must know who the target customer is. Create a buyer persona to provide a better glimpse at how the targeted customer thinks, behaves online, and engages. A high-level buyer persona can help one craft content that speaks directly to the “ideal” customer.

You also should have a clear grasp of the buyer’s journey and understand the various customer nuances at each stage of the journey. This customer insight allows one to cater to content that speaks to the customers at specific touch points throughout the journey. This type of targeted content can improve customer engagement and increase conversion rates.

Build a Content Marketing Strategy.

Brand awareness does not grow overnight but through strategic and targeted marketing. Simply writing content and posting it online is not enough. You must develop a plan that both matches the company brand and identifies with the customer.

Brand awareness is not a stand-alone strategy. You must embrace it at all levels of the company.

Make sure all key players are on board and understand the company’s mission, value, and vision, as well as what the “ideal” customer looks like.

Maintaining a detailed editorial calendar can keep the team on task and help make sure the flow of content is meeting company goals. Your focus also should be on delivering relevant content that resonates with the customer.

Monitor Content.

Online content can get out of control if not managed properly. Just one unanswered comment on a post could make the company appear unresponsive. To make sure the brand remains consistent, monitor online content continuously and respond to or remove comments as necessary.

Analyze and Adjust.

The last thing one would want to do is go through the steps of building a content marketing campaign and then not evaluate its effectiveness. Analyze key metrics and determine if the campaign delivered the desired results. Track metrics such as content reach, engagement, and conversion to get a clear picture of each content type’s efficacy.

Having this analytical data in front of one can help one determine what content resonates with the customer and where adjustments need to be made. You can then better strategize the content to maximize its overall impact.

As one can see, content marketing is more than just a write-it-and-post-it strategy. To be heard in today’s busy and chaotic marketplace, companies must work to build brand awareness within their content. This is the only way to differentiate yourself from the competitors and tell customers why they should choose your goods or services.

Issue #2: The published content damages the brand image.

Suggested solution:

Avoid content that only aims at making a sale. The content that you create should educate someone on a topic. Content that blatantly sells or blasts your brand’s message

in someone's face does not work. The goal should be to educate your audience on a topic in the genre that your brand falls into, not write about your brand.

There is a good test to do before you publish any post: Read through it and ask yourself if a reader could guess that it was written by your brand if they didn't have any author information to look for. Hint: the answer should be "no." Suggested solution: Focus on customer education

Customer education:

Customer education is a way to help your customers become well-informed buyers of your products. As a result, customers will be even more satisfied with a product or service, because they will be completely informed on what to expect before purchasing it. Customer education can come in many different forms, including learning programs implemented with learning management systems or in-person interactions.

The Benefits

A business has immense benefits to reap from educating customers. If it fails to do so, the customers will find the information themselves anyway, but the business loses valuable points it could have scored with the customers, or worse – the customers switch to a competitor that empowers and teaches them how they can get the most out of the product at hand. Here are 3 benefits of educating your customers:

1. **It Builds Customer Trust:** In an era where companies use various marketing ploys to lure as many prospects as possible into using their products, customers are more likely to trust those brands that make an effort to enhance their knowledge about the nature of their products. Research has shown that educating customers strengthens their trust in an organization, and it can act as an important service differentiator for brands.

"The smart consumer will opt to buy from the company that's educated him on the issue and presented him with multiple solutions. That company's selflessness has built trust – and its ability to teach him has bought his loyalty in the future" – Mark Quinn (Kelechi, 2017).

2. **It Reduces Complaints:** Besides building customer trust, educating customers will lead to a reduction in complaints as the customers become more adept at solving a good number of problems related to the product(s) on their own. This eases pressure on support channels and enables support staff to handle other issues.

When support staff can pay more attention to other tasks, they become more productive. This is possible since fewer customers are calling or emailing them for assistance on basic issues.

3. **It Enhances Customer Loyalty:** When customers know and understand a product, its features, capabilities, and limitations, it gives them realistic expectations on what they can achieve with the product. This deep understanding of a brand's product or service is very important for building trust.

Educating your customers helps them understand your products better and build trust with your brand. Without this trust, loyalty will not be possible.

18.6 CONTENT-ASSOCIATED FAILURE IN POSITIONING THE COMPANY AS AN EXPERT

Objective 3: To find challenges and propose solutions to when the published content fails to position the company as an expert of their domain.

Many organizations use content marketing strategies for lead generation and lead conversion. Organizations try to attract target an audience through engaging content and by positioning themselves as authorities in their industry.

Organizations try to be their audience's one-stop resource for getting the latest industry news, relevant how-to information videos, emerging trends, and much more. But evaluating the content marketing efforts is necessary to know whether the content marketing strategy is effective enough to position the company as an authority in its industry. Here are a few issues that a company may face in the process of establishing itself as an authority in the industry (Hajimahmud et al., 2022).

Issue #1: The website fails to attract traffic.

Generating traffic is the primary aim of every website, but business owners should be careful and ensure that their digital marketing campaign generates mostly targeted traffic. One of the implications of failure to generate traffic is failed attempts at positioning the company as an expert of its domain.

Suggested solution: Increase the effectivity of keywords.

Through Google analytics, one can know whether the keywords are actually sending traffic or not. They take the data from Google as well as other search engines to measure the keywords in terms of their effectiveness in sending traffic.

In the past, one of the aims of keyword research was to stuff the content with terms people were looking for and artificially push pages to the top of the search results. Quality was often seen as less important than the right keyword density – having a certain percentage of the same keyword within the content (Rana et al., 2021).

That kind of approach no longer works. In fact, it's more often penalized than rewarded. Google keeps tweaking how its search algorithms work to try to deliver search results more relevant to what people want to find (Khanh & Khang, 2021).

Why Do Keyword Research?

Keywords are an important SEO ranking factor that Google uses when it's deciding where to rank the content in search results. Get them right, and Google will understand what the content is about, making it easy for it to pop up at the right time in response to a search.

Keyword research helps one get into the customers' heads by finding topics to include in the content strategy. When one knows what the target audience is looking for, one can optimize the content to deliver the answers they need.

Overall, keyword research supports not just content creation, but all marketing and promotional activities, including email marketing. It will also help with pay-per-click advertising and competitive research.

Checking out the keywords that the competitors are targeting can help one refine their own content strategy.

Where to Use Keywords in Content?

Once one has a final list of keywords, then one can use this information in lots of places in the content.

Using keywords to optimize the content is a whole other topic, but one can get started by using keywords in:

- **The title of the page:** That's both the actual title and the SEO title, which might be slightly different. The title's a starting point for Google determining relevance, and it's the clickable link one see in search results.
- **The meta description:** If one doesn't use an SEO tool, then this will automatically come from the first 160 characters of the content, so that's a good place to use keywords too. The meta description provides the description that's below the clickable link and helps people decide to click – or not.
- **In links and social media updates:** If a company is sharing site content, this may already be part of the title, but one can also help people refine their searches by adding an appropriate hashtag, which is also effectively a keyword.

Suggested solution: Creation of quality content

To drive organic traffic to the site, one needs to develop customer-centric content. The content needs to address the customer questions, concerns, and issues. One can perform competitive research to understand which topics the competitors in the industry are focusing on. Conducting detail audience research by poll on social media, through buyer personas can identify the interest areas of the target audience.

Content is king in content marketing, and the audience decides the topic, style, and types of the content. Good content is what sets the website apart from the masses and delivers the right message into the hearts and minds of the customers.

The success of a website is determined primarily by its content. Ultimately, content wins the wallets of the customers. All other components of the website (design, visuals, videos, etc.) provide a secondary support role. If the company has effective taglines, great design will only enhance its effectiveness. The design itself does not sell.

The content of the website should always begin with proper market research. First, one should determine the high-value customers (HVC) and define personas for the website. Then one should determine how one will target them.

Taglines and slogans that are customer-centric (i.e., focus on the needs and wants of the customer) are essential to capturing the attention of the prospective customers. Your taglines must deliver a clear value proposition and include an effective call to action. The key to a successful website is having clear, relevant, and keyword-rich content that delivers the right message with power and conviction.

The content on the website should target the audience, engage them, and persuade them to take action.

Suggested solution: Heighten the level of trust

This can be ascertained by finding out the percentage of blog subscribers, which can be calculated by dividing the number of visitors by the number of subscribers. This metric will help to determine if the audience considers content in blogs as a trusted resource of the relevant information required by them. To put it in simple words, the audience researches something on search engines, and one provides them with required information to get organic traffic to the site. If the content is not effective enough to gain the trust, attention, and confidence of the target audience then all content marketing efforts go waste.

Eight characteristics of content that develop trust.

1. Content that develops trust is written for enthusiasts by enthusiasts.

Even though a slight change of attitude can make one influential, creating with passion rather than pomposity has its own benefits.

People consume content in different ways and for many reasons – while some read to pass time, others do it to find a solution to a problem. Then again, there are those who devour their daily portions in the hope of getting inspired.

2. Content that develops trust shows a deep level of understanding and experience.

Solution-seekers are a different audience. While researching their problem, they pay close attention to what they read and trust nothing but content written with experience and expertise.

Expert content has to be insightful and useful. It requires a deep understanding of the topic and provides resolutions written by authorities in the industry. Such high-quality content comes from both first-hand experience and comprehensive research, thereby enveloping a wide range of proven suggestions, tips, and solutions that readers can trust and apply.

To develop trust, the words should exude enthusiasm and expertise at the same time. It may seem hard to reconcile these discursive differences, but consider this: When written in simple, conversational language, expert content can be both informational and exciting.

3. Content that develops trust provides plenty of quality references to back up its main point.

While link building has an irreplaceable spot in content marketing, the potential of source linking is mostly unleveraged. Data-driven content can establish one as an expert, but these articles need to be backed up by the data's original context.

The line between creation and curation is a thin one. If crossed, it can diminish the credibility of the entire brand, but if maintained with source links and quality references, it actually builds it (Khang et al., 2022a).

4. Content that develops trust avoids marketing clichés and offers a dose of honesty.

In the digital publishing age, there are plenty of content creators to compete with. If one doesn't have anything original to show, one won't be able

to stand out from the crowd. But if one develops a whole marketing strategy around transparency, the competitive edge is yours.

5. Content that develops trust is straightforward, succinct and to-the-point.

It comes down to professionalism and respectability. Both are established through content that says what it means and means what it says. However, complex the topic is, avoid vague language; be succinct and stay to the point.

6. Content that develops trust doesn't insult the reader's intelligence.

Quality suffers from quantity, and that's content marketing's biggest trap. Those who fall into it are mostly overwhelmed by the workflow, which is something we can all relate to.

If the content is the brand's main building block, then "don't insult the reader's intelligence" is the number one rule. Your audience expects quality and rarely forgives inconsistency, and it's up to you to respect that. Whatever it is that the company is writing about, it needs to be highly relevant (Khang et al., 2022b).

7. Content that develops trust is consistent and uses a uniquely recognizable style.

Finding your own, unique voice is one of the biggest aspects of building a brand. Your message can exude luxury or promise adventure – regardless of what kind of experience one chooses to provide, it still needs to be recognizable and consistent.

These requirements are the two sides of the coin: the one that attracts and the one that converts.

More importantly, they both speak on behalf of prowess, creativity, and dedication. Content that's easily recognizable is original and inventive, while consistency showcases the passion and professionalism.

8. Content that develops trust is relatable and uses a more personal tone.

The last characteristic of content that develops trust serves as comedy relief for both you and the readers. It's what allows you to break character as an expert and reveal yourself as a human. This "relatability" strategy is often used in social media campaigns but can be effective in content marketing too.

While trying to write about complicated things in plain words and short sentences, a bit of humor, if the topic allows, can make the content interesting and help readers relate. Humor triggers emotions and reminds the audience that their content provider is a person, just like them.

9. The same goes for first-person writing and using a direct tone.

It's much easier to trust advice when somebody gives it from personal experience, isn't it? Whenever you can, back up the points with your own real-life examples. Address the audience as if you were talking to them face-to-face, and they'll find you friendly and affable. Brands are built to appeal to real people, so don't try to stand higher than them.

The importance of brand trust can't be overstressed. If you choose to build it with content, then make sure it conveys passion and expertise in an honest, succinct, unique, and relatable way.